The components of our income tax provision (benefit) were as follows:

| *(In millions)* | Year Ended December 31, 2019 | 2018 | 2017 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Current tax expense: | | | |
| Federal | $ 62.3 | $ 228.2 | $ 79.6 |
| State and local | 4.6 | 9.8 | 14.3 |
| Foreign | 64.1 | 59.8 | 106.0 |
| **Total current expense** | **$ 131.0** | **$ 297.8** | **$ 199.9** |
| Deferred tax (benefit) expense: | | | |
| Federal | $ (19.0) | $ 56.8 | $ 130.1 |
| State and local | 4.0 | (21.2) | 5.3 |
| Foreign | (39.4) | (25.9) | (4.8) |
| **Total deferred tax (benefit) expense** | **(54.4)** | **9.7** | **130.6** |
| **Total income tax provision** | **$ 76.6** | **$ 307.5** | **$ 330.5** |

Deferred tax assets (liabilities) consist of the following:

| *(In millions)* | December 31, 2019 | 2018 |
|---|---|---|
| Accruals not yet deductible for tax purposes | $ 17.4 | $ 17.5 |
| Net operating loss carryforwards | 245.9 | 265.5 |
| Foreign, federal and state credits | 8.4 | 10.4 |
| Employee benefit items | 79.5 | 77.0 |
| Capitalized expenses | 32.2 | 8.9 |
| Intangibles | 21.8 | — |
| Derivatives and other | 47.7 | 38.0 |
| **Sub-total deferred tax assets** | **452.9** | **417.3** |
| Valuation allowance | (197.6) | (218.4) |
| **Total deferred tax assets** | **$ 255.3** | **$ 198.9** |
| | | |
| Depreciation and amortization | $ (37.0) | $ (26.8) |
| Unremitted foreign earnings | (10.0) | — |
| Intangible assets | — | (21.7) |
| Other | (0.4) | (0.4) |
| **Total deferred tax liabilities** | **(47.4)** | **(48.9)** |
| **Net deferred tax assets** | **$ 207.9** | **$ 150.0** |

A valuation allowance has been provided based on the uncertainty of utilizing the tax benefits, mainly related to the following deferred tax assets:

- $183.4 million of foreign items, primarily net operating losses; and
- $7.7 million of state tax credits.

For the year ended December 31, 2019, the valuation allowance decreased by $20.8 million. This is primarily driven by our Reinvent SEE initiatives and decreases in foreign tax rates.

As of December 31, 2019, we have foreign net operating loss carryforwards of $899.4 million expiring in years beginning in 2020 with the majority of losses having an unlimited carryover. The state net operating loss carryforwards totaling $569.3 million expire in various amounts over 1 to 19 years.